

CUB SCOUT PACK 376

BEAR Parent Guide

3rd Grade • 2026–2027 Scouting Year

Bears are third graders. They can handle longer walks, simple tools, and more responsibility within the den.

Welcome to the Bear year! Third graders step up to a one-mile hike, their first pocketknife (if they choose the Whittling elective), and more hands-on citizenship. Den and pack meetings carry most of the program, with a few at-home items. Here's the full year at a glance.

How Your Scout Earns the Bear Badge

To earn the Bear rank badge, your Scout completes all 6 required adventures below, plus at least 2 elective adventures of their choosing. Most of this is done together as a den at meetings and pack events. Your den leader tracks progress and gives final sign-off.

The 6 Required Adventures

Adventure	What your Scout will work on	Where
Bobcat <i>Character & Leadership</i>	Learn the Scout Oath and Law, help create a den Code of Conduct, learn the denner role and signs, and complete the child-protection booklet at home.	Den + Home
Bear Habitat <i>Outdoors</i>	Plan and take a one-mile walk using Leave No Trace — map the route, handle trash, spot wildlife signs, and be kind to others on the trail.	Den / Family
Bear Strong <i>Personal Fitness</i>	Sample food groups, do 30 minutes of stretching and moving plus 15 minutes of heart-pumping exercise and a relaxing activity, and review the health form with you.	Den + Home
Paws for Action <i>Citizenship</i>	Learn U.S. flag history and handling, national symbols, how a non-profit works, and take part in a service project.	Den + Pack
Standing Tall <i>Personal Safety</i>	Watch the Protect Yourself Rules video, complete the Personal Space Bubble worksheet, set a family device policy, and learn about safety gear.	Home + Den
Fellowship <i>Family & Reverence</i>	Talk about your family's faith traditions, attend a service, do an act of kindness, and learn about a different faith.	Family

Family & Reverence note: this adventure can also be earned by completing the religious emblem of your family's choosing.

Choosing Elective Adventures (pick at least 2)

Your Scout chooses at least 2 of these to round out the year. The den usually does a few of them together, and your Scout can add more for fun or to earn extra recognition:

Elective Adventures

A Bear Goes Fishing • Balancing Bears • Baloo the Builder • Bears Afloat • Bears on Bikes • Champions for Nature • Chef Tech • Critter Care • Forensics • Let's Camp • Marble Madness • Race Time • Roaring Laughter • Salmon Run • Summertime Fun • Super Science • Whittling

Shooting Sports (Archery, BB Gun, Slingshot): optional electives that can only be earned at a council camp with certified instructors — not at regular pack meetings.

Year at a Glance — What to Plan For

Here's the quick summary of the bigger commitments across the 10-month scouting year (roughly September through June):

Overnights	None required to earn the badge. One optional overnight if your Scout picks the "Let's Camp" elective — the pack usually offers a campout you can use.
Service project	One service project. No minimum hours. The pack organizes at least one each year.
Outdoor / hiking	One one-mile walk practicing Leave No Trace.
Swimming & water	Optional only — "Bears Afloat" requires passing the BSA swimmer test before certain requirements. "Salmon Run" does not require passing the full swimmer test (den activities or swim lessons also qualify). Both are done with qualified adult supervision.
Shooting sports	Optional only — Archery, BB Gun, and Slingshot are available at council camps with certified instructors.
Parent involvement	Not required at every meeting. Note: the "Whittling" elective introduces a first pocketknife under close supervision.

What We Need From You at Home

A few items are done at home with your Scout. Everything else happens at den and pack meetings:

- Complete the "How to Protect Your Children from Child Abuse: A Parent's Guide" booklet activities (part of Bobcat).
- Watch the Bear Protect Yourself Rules video together and complete the Personal Space Bubble worksheet.
- Set a family policy for digital devices (part of Standing Tall).
- Review the BSA Annual Health and Medical Record together (part of Bear Strong).
- Talk about your family's faith traditions and attend a service or gathering.

Tips for a Great Year

- Come to den and pack meetings — that's where most adventures are earned.
- Watch for the pack calendar so you can plan around campouts, the Pinewood Derby, and service projects.
- Keep the handbook handy and celebrate each adventure as it's completed.
- Ask your den leader anytime you're unsure what's coming up next.

Questions? Reach out to your den leader or pack leadership — we're glad to help.